

What Is Existence?

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The question: What is Existence? What exists? Does the thing that exists begin at some time?

This study reviews these questions from the standpoint of **Madhyasth Darshan** (Co-existentialism), then compares its answer with **Advaita Vedanta** and selected **modern philosophical approaches** to physical reality, consciousness, and selfhood.

Quick Glossary

Term	Plain meaning
Existence	In Madhyasth Darshan: beingness and indestructibility, always present as coexistence.
Coexistence (<i>sah-astitva</i>)	Reality as Omnipresence and all units inseparably present together.
Omnipresence / Omnipotence / Space / Brahma / Satta	The all-pervasive, formless, non-transforming reality in which all units are saturated. The published translation's primary term is <i>Omnipotence</i> (used interchangeably here with <i>Omnipresence</i>); the source also names it Uniform/Equilibrium Energy, Space, Knowledge, Consciousness, God, and Absolute Energy. "Consciousness" here is one name for this pervasive reality and should not be read as a knowing subject — sentience (<i>chaitanya</i>) proper belongs to <i>jeevan</i> .
Unit	A countable, bounded entity in nature, whether insentient or sentient.
Jeevan	The sentient self: a real, immortal, constitutionally complete unit that works through the body.
Jada / *Chaitanya*	Insentient and sentient nature.
Atman / *Brahman*	In Advaita Vedanta: the Self and the one ultimate reality, finally identical.
Mithya	In Advaita: the world as dependent appearance, neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being.
Sat-Chit-Ananda	In Advaita: the threefold nature of Brahman / the true Self — being (<i>sat</i>), consciousness (<i>chit</i>), bliss (<i>ananda</i>).

Term	Plain meaning
Physicalism	The modern view that every real concrete phenomenon is physical.
Panpsychism	The view that experientiality belongs, at least in primitive form, to fundamental physical reality.
Illusionism	The view that phenomenal consciousness, as philosophers usually conceive it, is an illusion or misdescription.

1. The Madhyasth Darshan Answer

The claim in one sentence: Existence is the eternally present coexistence of formless Omnipresence and countless sentient and insentient units saturated in it; what exists never arises from non-existence and is never annihilated, though units undergo motion, transformation, development, and awakening.

1.1 What is Existence?

Madhyasth Darshan does not define existence as an object among objects, nor as a mental category imposed by a knower. It defines existence as the inseparable presence of **Omnipresence** and **nature**.

SB gives the most compressed formulation:

“What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present. Upon examining their fundamental nature, we learn that all of existence is essentially nature (matter) saturated in Omnipotence (consciousness). Here, ‘seeing’ is intended in the sense of understanding. Since nature saturated in Omnipotence is inseparably present, existence itself is eternally manifest in the form of coexistence.” - SB, p. 48

A note on the word “consciousness” here. The published translation lists several names for this pervasive reality (Satta): Uniform Energy, Space, Knowledge, Consciousness, Omnipresence, Eternity, God, and Absolute Energy. The parenthetical “(consciousness)” therefore labels the all-pervasive reality, not a personal knowing mind. Sentience as the activity of a knower (*chaitanya*) is, in Madhyasth Darshan, the status of *jeevan*, not of Omnipresence itself. Keeping these distinct is essential: Omnipresence is the pervasive ground in which units are saturated; sentience is not a property of that ground but of constitutionally complete units.

The same passage immediately rejects two familiar origin stories:

1. Matter does not arise from consciousness.

2. Consciousness does not arise from matter.

Madhyasth Darshan's alternative is not creation from one into the other, but **inseparable presentness**: sentient and insentient nature are saturated in Omnipresence, and that indivisible presence is existence.

MVD states the same ontology in the language of "Realisation Knowledge":

"Sentient and insentient nature saturated in Omnipotence. The countless sentient and insentient units are saturated in Omnipotence (Omnipresence)." - MVD, p. 11

"All units saturated in the Omnipresence (permeative and transparent) have form, properties, essential nature & dharma, and have inherent orderliness & participate in overall orderliness." - MVD, p. 11

So existence has two inseparable aspects:

1. **Omnipresence** - formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, immeasurable.
2. **Units of nature** - formful, countable, bounded, active, mutually related.

SB makes this distinction explicit:

"Omnipotence is formless, and nature within Omnipotence is formful existence. Existence implies beingness and indestructibility." - SB, p. 49

This is the key sentence for the present paper. For Madhyasth Darshan, to exist is not merely to appear to a mind, nor merely to be measurable by instruments. To exist is **to be** and **not to be annihilable**.

1.2 What Exists?

Madhyasth Darshan says that what exists is **coexistence itself**: Omnipresence and all units saturated in it. What exists is not formless reality alone, with plurality treated as mere appearance; nor is it physicochemical matter alone, with sentience reduced to bodily process. Its ontology can be stated in four layers.

1. Omnipresence exists. It is formless, all-pervasive, and not confined by dimensions:

"Omnipotence is not confined within any dimension of length or breadth, nor can any measure be established for it; therefore, Omnipotence is all-pervasive." - SB, p. 49

MVD also identifies this Omnipresence with Space:

“Knowledge itself is the omnipresent Omnipotence. This itself is referred to as Space.” - MVD, p. 35

This does not make Space a personal God or an individual consciousness. It is the all-pervasive, non-transforming reality in which all units are present, conserved, regulated, and energised.

2. Countless units exist. Units are not illusions in Omnipresence. They have determinate reality:

“Nature, saturated in Omnipotence, exists as countless units. Each unit, being saturated in Omnipotence, remains surrounded, submerged, and soaked in it.” - SB, p. 48

Every unit has form, properties, essential nature, and dharma. This means that to understand a thing is not merely to locate it or quantify it, but to understand what it is, how it behaves, what its orderliness is, and how it participates in the larger order.

3. Sentient and insentient nature both exist. Madhyasth Darshan explicitly refuses the reduction of existence to physicochemical matter:

“Existence is not just physicochemical matter, but all physical, chemical and jeevan entities are inseparably present in Omnipresence.” - MVD, The Alternative, point 7

This is why the human being is not treated as body alone. The body is a material organization; *jeevan* is a sentient unit operating through it. MVD states:

“Brahma (Omnipotence) is omnipresent, and jeevan-clouds are many.” - MVD, p. 13

“The grandeur of humans as a joint form of jeevan and body.” - MVD, p. 13

4. Relations and orderliness exist. Units do not exist as isolated lumps. Because existence is coexistence, every unit exists in mutuality:

“Since existence is coexistence, complementarity and mutual recognition are eternally established.” - SB, p. 49

This is why Madhyasth Darshan's ontology immediately becomes ethics, ecology, and social philosophy. If existence itself is coexistence, then right living is not an optional moral overlay; it is the human evidence of understanding existence correctly.

1.3 Does What Exists Begin at Some Time?

Madhyasth Darshan's answer is: **No, not in the sense of coming from non-existence.** That which exists does not begin as a new reality out of nothing. It is eternally present in existence, though its form, condition, configuration, body, role, and expression may change. SB states this without ambiguity:

"That which exists continues to be, and that which was not, does not come into existence. Therefore, existence will remain as it is till eternity." - SB, p. 49

JV states the same principle in language closer to ordinary life:

"Nothing arrives at birth nor does anything depart with death. All that is, exists forever." - JV, p. 20

This does not mean that Madhyasth Darshan denies change. It distinguishes **annihilation** from **transformation**, **birth** from **embodiment**, and **death** from **disassociation of body and jeevan**. JV illustrates this with a physical example:

"A piece of charcoal continues to exist in other forms even after burning it." - JV, p. 20

JV makes the metaphysical rule explicit:

"At the fundamental level, a 'reality' never gets annihilated." - JV, p. 20

The result is a strong conservation ontology:

1. **Existence as coexistence is beginningless and endless.**
2. **Omnipresence does not begin, change, or end.**
3. **Units do not arise from non-being and do not vanish into non-being.**
4. **Particular bodies, configurations, relations, and states do begin and end.**
5. **Development and awakening are real, but they are not creation out of nothing.**

1.4 Development Without Creation From Nothing

Madhyasth Darshan's answer becomes more subtle in its account of *jeevan*. It does say that an atom becomes constitutionally complete and attains sentient status. But this is not "consciousness emerging from dead matter" in the modern emergentist sense. It is a development within already existing coexistence.

SB describes this transition:

"In the course of an atom's development, there comes a stage when the required number of particles for its constitution are all integrated, and at that point, it becomes constitutionally complete. Constitutional completeness signifies satisfaction within, by, and for that constitution. This is the immortality of the result, and the attainment of sentient status." - SB, p. 59

And then:

"All types of atoms, including constitutionally complete ones, are eternally present through the natural law of coexistence in existence." - SB, p. 59

This gives Madhyasth Darshan a distinctive position:

Question	Madhyasth Darshan answer
Did existence begin?	No. Existence is eternally present coexistence.
Did units begin from non-existence?	No. "That which was not, does not come into existence."
Do bodies begin and end?	Yes. Birth and death are events at the level of body and association.
Does <i>jeevan</i> begin at birth?	No. <i>Jeevan</i> is immortal; birth and death are occurrences.
Does sentient status have a developmental account?	Yes. Constitutional completeness is described as attainment of sentient status, but within eternal coexistence, not as creation from nothing.

1.5 Brahma Is Truth, the World Is Perpetual

MVD compresses the coexistential ontology into one line:

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.” - MVD, p. 13

This is not a minor rhetorical flourish. It states a metaphysical commitment: Brahma (Omnipresence) and the world of units are both real, neither cancelled by the other.

If the world is perpetual, then:

1. Matter is not ultimately negated.
2. Relations are not merely provisional.
3. Human conduct is not merely preparatory to escape from the world.
4. Nature, society, production, justice, prosperity, and ecological balance are all real domains of evidence.

Madhyasth Darshan therefore rejects two reductions that would split this inseparable whole:

1. **Material reductionism:** only physicochemical matter exists.
2. **World-negating spiritualism:** only the formless ground is finally real and the world is diminished to mere appearance.

Its positive claim is: **Brahma is real, the world is real, and their inseparable presentness is coexistence.**

2. The Advaita Vedanta Answer

The claim in one sentence: Existence in the strictest sense is Brahman alone, one without a second; the world of names, forms, bodies, and relations is *mithya*, a dependent appearance, and the true Self is not born or destroyed because it is identical with Brahman.

2.1 Existence Alone, One Without a Second

The Chandogya Upanishad gives the classical Advaita starting point:

“In the beginning this was Existence alone, One only, without a second.”
- CU 6.2.1

Shankara’s commentary glosses *sat* as:

“mere Existence, a thing that is subtle, without distinction, all pervasive, one, taintless, partless, consciousness” - CU 6.2.1, Shankara commentary

The text also rejects the idea that existence comes from non-existence:

“By what logic can existence verily come out of non-existence? But surely, o good looking one, in the beginning all this was Existence, One only, without a second.” - CU 6.2.2

Advaita thus denies that absolute existence could arise from non-existence. The further Advaita question is what the many things of the world amount to within that one Existence.

2.2 Sat-Chit-Ananda: Being, Consciousness, Bliss

A second classical Advaita formulation names existence not only as *sat* — bare being — but as **Sat-Chit-Ananda**: being-consciousness-bliss. This is not three separate realities added together. In Advaita, Brahman / the true Self is one partless reality whose nature is expressed in these three inseparable names.

The Taittiriya Upanishad gives an early root of the formula when it defines Brahman as:

“Truth, knowledge, infinite.” - TU 2.1

Shankara’s tradition reads *satyam* as being or reality, *jnanam* as consciousness, and *anantam* as the infinite — not finite, not bounded by name and form. The *anandamaya* sheath passage in the same Upanishad (TU 2.5) then leads the seeker beyond even bliss as a sheath to the Self beyond all coverings. Shankara states the mature Advaita formula in the *Vivekachudamani*:

“I am of the nature of Existence-Consciousness-Bliss. I am the very Self, indestructible and ever unchanging.”

This is the meditative rendering of Shankara’s teaching at *Vivekachudamani* v. 152 (trans. Swami Madhavananda):

“By that alone he comes to know his own Self as Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute and becomes happy.” - VC, v. 152

The same triad appears again at v. 217, where the Self “makes Itself felt as the Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute” within the heart. Shankara’s Sanskrit idiom is *sat-cit-ananda*; the published translation uses “Existence-Knowledge-Bliss” for the same formula.

In this scheme:

1. **Sat** — Existence is not a property Brahman happens to have; Brahman *is* existence. To exist in the absolute sense is to be Brahman.

2. **Chit** — Consciousness is not a function of mind or brain; it is the very nature of reality and Self. The seer, seeing, and light of awareness are finally one.
3. **Ananda** — Bliss is not mere pleasure or emotion; it is the intrinsic fullness of the Self free from lack, fear, and dependence on objects.

So for Advaita, the question “what is existence?” receives a concentrated answer: **existence is the one reality that is being, consciousness, and bliss without a second**. The world of bodies, minds, and relations does not add a second kind of existence; it appears within, and is finally sublated by, that one.

2.3 What Exists in Advaita?

Advaita’s strict answer is: **Brahman alone exists absolutely**. The world is not sheer nothing, but it is not absolutely real either. It is *mithya*: dependent appearance.

Shankara, in the *Vivekachudamani*, states the discrimination between real and unreal:

“A firm conviction of the mind to the effect that Brahman is real and the universe unreal, is designated as discrimination (Viveka) between the Real and the unreal.” - VC, v. 20 (trans. Swami Madhavananda)

On the identity of *jiva* and Brahman he teaches:

“The individual soul is itself and directly the Supreme Brahman, and nothing else.” - VC, v. 216

It also gives the clay-pot analogy:

“All modifications of clay, such as the jar, which are always accepted by the mind as real, are (in reality) nothing but clay. Similarly, this entire universe which is produced from the real Brahman, is Brahman Itself and nothing but That.” - VC, v. 251

For Advaita, then, the question “what exists?” has two levels:

Level	What exists?	Status of world
Empirical (<i>vyavahara</i>)	Bodies, minds, causes, effects, duties, scriptures, practices	Operationally valid
Absolute (<i>paramartha</i>)	Brahman alone	World is <i>mithya</i> , dependent appearance

2.4 Does What Exists Begin?

For Advaita, Brahman does not begin. It is beginningless, partless, actionless, and non-dual. The universe as name-form appearance has origination at the empirical level, but its material and ultimate truth is Brahman. Creation is therefore not absolute production out of nothing; it is manifestation or appearance of names and forms on the basis of Brahman.

Shankara expresses the Self's changelessness repeatedly in the *Vivekachudamani*:

“Brahman is Existence, Knowledge, Infinity, pure, supreme, self-existent, eternal and indivisible Bliss, not different (in reality) from the individual soul, and devoid of interior or exterior.” - VC, v. 225

“The Supreme Brahman is, like the sky, pure, absolute, infinite, motionless and changeless, devoid of interior or exterior, the One Existence, without a second, and one's own Self.” - VC, v. 393

3. Modern Philosophical Approaches

The claim in one sentence: Modern philosophy has no single answer to existence; it usually begins from the physical universe and public evidence, but contemporary debates about consciousness, selfhood, and experience show that “what exists” remains contested.

The references available here are mainly modern philosophy of mind and cognitive science, not cosmology. Therefore this section does not claim to settle whether the physical universe began in a Big Bang, or whether spacetime is fundamental. It compares Madhyasth Darshan with modern approaches to **what kinds of things must be admitted as real**.

3.1 Standard Physicalism: Concrete Reality is Physical

Physicalism is the dominant modern background view. Strawson defines it plainly:

“I take physicalism to be the view that every real, concrete phenomenon in the universe is...physical.” - Strawson 2006, p. 2

On this approach, what exists are physical things, events, fields, organisms, brains, bodies, and their processes. Minds and selves are not separate substances. They are functions, organizations, models, or processes of physical systems.

Modern self-model theories follow this line. Limanowski and Blankenburg describe minimal selfhood as emerging from embodied self-modeling:

“minimal selfhood emerges as the result” - *Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 1*

They further summarize free-energy accounts as explaining selfhood through embodied predictive models:

“In one sentence, these accounts propose to ‘understand the elusive sense of minimal self in terms of having internal models that successfully predict or match the sensory consequences of our own movement, our intentions in action, and our sensory input’.” - *Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 3*

This is almost the opposite of Madhyasth Darshan’s *jeevan* ontology. For Madhyasth Darshan, the self is a real sentient unit using the body. For the self-model approach, the self is a model generated by embodied prediction and integration.

3.2 The Hard Problem: Experience Resists Reduction

Physicalism faces the problem of experience. Chalmers formulates it as the “hard problem”:

“The really hard problem of consciousness is the problem of experience. When we think and perceive, there is a whirl of information-processing, but there is also a subjective aspect.” - *Chalmers 1995, p. 3*

He adds:

“It is widely agreed that experience arises from a physical basis, but we have no good explanation of why and how it so arises. Why should physical processing give rise to a rich inner life at all?” - *Chalmers 1995, p. 3*

Nagel makes the same difficulty vivid through the bat example, grounding it in his canonical formulation of what consciousness is:

“the fact that an organism has conscious experience at all means, basically, that there is something it is like to be that organism.” - *Nagel 1974, p. 1*

For Madhyasth Darshan, this is not merely a gap in explanation. It is evidence that the ontology of body alone is incomplete. The modern physicalist may reply that an explanatory gap is not proof of *jeevan*. This is the central disagreement.

3.3 Panpsychist Physicalism: Experience as Fundamental

Strawson accepts physicalism but argues that a realistic physicalism cannot deny experience. He writes:

“Full recognition of the reality of experience, then, is the obligatory starting point for any remotely realistic version of physicalism.” -
Strawson 2006, p. 2

He then argues that experience cannot emerge from the wholly non-experiential:

“Experiential phenomena cannot be emergent from wholly non-experiential phenomena.” - *Strawson 2006, p. 12*

And concludes:

“Real physicalism, realistic physicalism, entails panpsychism.” -
Strawson 2006, p. 12

This comes closer to Madhyasth Darshan than reductive physicalism does, because both refuse the idea that sentience simply appears from wholly non-sentient being. But the agreement is limited.

Madhyasth Darshan does **not** say every particle is a subject of experience. It says sentience is the status of constitutionally complete atoms, while other atoms remain engaged in physical and chemical activity. Strawson’s panpsychism and Madhyasth Darshan both challenge dead-matter reductionism, but they do so with different metaphysical structures.

3.4 Illusionism: Phenomenal Consciousness as Misdescription

Illusionism goes in the opposite direction. Frankish writes:

“Another approach, which holds that phenomenal consciousness is an illusion and aims to explain why it seems to exist.” - *Frankish 2016, p. 1*

He clarifies that illusionists deny phenomenal properties, not all consciousness-talk:

“illusionists deny the existence of phenomenal consciousness properly so-called, but do not deny the existence of a form of consciousness” -
Frankish 2016, p. 8

Madhyasth Darshan would regard this as another form of reductionism. It treats lived experience, valuation, aspiration, and realization as activities of *jeevan*, not as illusions produced by a brain-model. But illusionism is philosophically important because it shows how far modern naturalism may go to preserve a physicalist ontology.

3.5 Does What Exists Begin in Modern Philosophy?

The modern references used here do not supply a single answer. A cautious comparison is:

1. **Physicalism:** particular organisms, brains, stars, and bodies begin and end; the question of whether the total physical universe begins belongs to cosmology and fundamental physics, not to the philosophy-of-mind sources used here.
2. **Self-model theories:** the self begins developmentally as embodied modeling capacities arise; there is no eternal individual self.
3. **Panpsychism:** experientiality may belong to fundamental physical reality; particular minds still depend on organization.
4. **Illusionism:** phenomenal consciousness never begins, because phenomenal consciousness in the realist sense does not exist; what begins are quasi-phenomenal representational and cognitive states.

Compared with all of these, Madhyasth Darshan makes a stronger metaphysical claim: existence as coexistence is eternal, units are not annihilated, and *jeevan* is immortal.

It must be stated plainly that this section sidesteps the sharpest modern challenge to the claim that existence is beginningless. The third question - “does the thing that exists begin at some time?” - is most directly contested not in philosophy of mind but in physical cosmology, where standard Big Bang cosmology and debates over whether time and spacetime themselves had a beginning bear directly on it. The sources used here are philosophy of mind, which says little about origins, so the comparison should not be taken to show that Madhyasth Darshan’s eternalism has met the strongest modern objection. A fuller treatment would have to engage cosmology directly, where the live disagreement actually lies.

4. Comparison

Sections 1–3 state each position on its own terms. This section gathers the contrasts in one place.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
What is existence?	Eternally present coexistence: Omnipresence plus all units saturated in it.	Brahman / Existence alone, one without a second.	Concrete physical reality, studied empirically.
What exists absolutely?	Omnipresence and real units, sentient and insentient.	Brahman alone.	Usually the physical; experience disputed.
Is the world real?	Yes. "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."	Empirically valid but ultimately <i>mithya</i> .	Yes, as physical reality.
Does existence begin?	No. What exists does not come from non-existence.	Brahman does not begin.	Particular systems begin and end; cosmology unsettled.
Does the individual self begin?	<i>Jeevan</i> does not begin at birth or die with the body.	<i>Jiva</i> is ultimately Brahman; individuality is ignorance.	Self develops as biological/cognitive process.
What changes?	Forms, bodies, configurations, awakening.	Names and forms appear and are sublated; Brahman is changeless.	Physical and mental configurations change.
Method of knowing	Study, realization, behavior, experiment.	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination.	Observation, modelling, public evidence.
Ethical consequence	Humane conduct evidences understanding of coexistence.	Ethics prepares the mind for liberation.	Ethics via naturalism, social theory, or normative philosophy.

Agreement

Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita share one deep commitment: **existence does not arise from non-existence**. Modern physicalism is a weaker third party. It does not settle whether the totality of being had a beginning—that belongs to cosmology—and the philosophy-of-mind sources used here only say that minds arise within already-existing physical processes.

Disagreement

The decisive issue is **the status of plurality**.

- **Advaita** gives final reality to the One; the world is *mithya*, and liberation is recognising “I am Brahman.”
- **Physicalism** gives final reality to the physical; self and consciousness are usually process, model, or illusion.
- **Madhyasth Darshan** gives reality to both Omnipresence and the many: the world is perpetual, units are real, and coexistence is evidenced in conduct.

Advaita’s **Sat-Chit-Ananda** and Madhyasth Darshan’s **coexistence** can sound like the same answer to “what is existence?” Both speak of being, consciousness, and fulfilment. The contrast is not over whether those words appear, but over **what they name and whether the world survives them**.

For Advaita, *sat*, *chit*, and *ananda* are three names for **one** ultimate reality — Brahman / the true Self — without a second. Existence **is** that single being-consciousness-bliss; the world of units, bodies, and relations is finally *mithya*, resolved into that identity. Liberation is recognising “I am Brahman.”

For Madhyasth Darshan, the same vocabulary is **distributed across coexistence**, not compressed into one subject. **Being** is indestructible coexistence of Omnipresence and real units. **Consciousness** names the all-pervasive ground (*Satta*), while **sentience** (*chaitanya*) belongs to *jeevan*, not to Omnipresence itself. **Satisfaction and bliss** belong to real units in development and to awakening within the world — not to negating the world. The question is answered not by dissolving the many into one, but by understanding inseparable Omnipresence and units together.

Modern philosophy has no parallel formula. It may treat experience as physical, fundamental, or illusory, but it does not name existence as Sat-Chit-Ananda or as coexistence.

Madhyasth Darshan is therefore not simply “another non-dualism.” It affirms inseparable togetherness without erasing the many.

5. Critical Review

5.1 Strengths of the Madhyasth Darshan Position

1. **It answers the three questions directly.** Existence is beingness and indestructibility in the form of coexistence. What exists is Omnipresence and all units. What exists does not begin from non-being.
2. **It avoids world-negation.** By saying “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual,” it preserves the reality of nature, society, relationship, production, and ethical responsibility.

3. It avoids simple material reductionism. It refuses to treat consciousness, value, and selfhood as mere byproducts of body-chemistry.

4. It links ontology and conduct. If existence is coexistence, then human fulfillment must be evidenced as coexistence in behavior, not merely claimed as belief.

5. It gives a conservation-based metaphysics. The principle that nothing existent is annihilated gives internal coherence to its account of body, *jeevan*, death, transformation, and development.

5.2 Open Problems for Madhyasth Darshan

1. The leap from indestructibility to *jeevan* is not publicly established. The general claim that reality is not annihilated does not by itself prove that a distinct sentient unit survives bodily death.

2. Constitutional completeness is not yet scientifically operational. The claim that an atom becomes constitutionally complete and thereby attains sentient status is central to the darshan, but it is not presently measurable in physics or chemistry.

3. The interaction between *jeevan* and body needs clearer articulation. If *jeevan* drives the body, modern readers will ask how intention becomes neural and muscular activity.

4. The vocabulary of Omnipresence risks ambiguity. MVD and SB use names such as Space, Knowledge, Consciousness, Omnipotence, Brahma, God, and Absolute Energy. A rigorous presentation must prevent readers from collapsing these into Advaita Brahman, theistic God, physical energy, or psychological consciousness.

5. The evidence standard differs from modern science. Madhyasth Darshan cites realization, behavior, and experiment. Modern science will accept public behavioral evidence but will not accept private realization as establishing ontology without independent testability.

6. The “nothing is annihilated” principle must be reconciled with physics. The conservation ontology is illustrated with burning charcoal, where mass-energy is rearranged rather than destroyed, and at that level it aligns with the conservation laws of physics. But modern physics also describes processes that look, on their face, like annihilation and origination: particle-antiparticle annihilation, pair creation, and the creation and annihilation of particles in quantum field theory. Madhyasth Darshan can answer that these are transformations of conserved quantities (energy, charge, and other invariants) rather than passages into and out of absolute non-being - which is exactly its claim. But the paper does not yet make that argument explicit, and “a reality never gets annihilated” needs to be stated at the level of conserved being, not of particular particles, if it is to engage physics rather than be refuted by it.

5.3 Strengths and Limits of Advaita

Advaita has a powerful answer to non-being: existence cannot arise from non-existence. It also gives a rigorous first-person method of discriminating the seer from the seen. Its weakness, from the Madhyasth perspective, is that it makes the world dependent appearance. That makes it harder to ground the ultimate reality of relationships, nature, society, and humane conduct.

Advaita may reply that ethics and compassion remain valid at the empirical level, and that realization of non-duality deepens rather than weakens them. Madhyasth Darshan's counter-reply is that an ontology which makes the world *mithya* cannot give the world the same final weight as coexistence gives it.

5.4 Strengths and Limits of Modern Approaches

Modern approaches are strongest where Madhyasth Darshan is weakest: public evidence, empirical correction, cognitive modelling, and precise mechanisms. Self-model theory can explain many features of embodied selfhood without positing an eternal *jeevan*. Illusionism shows how a naturalist can reinterpret even the seeming obviousness of phenomenal consciousness.

But modern philosophy is not unified. Chalmers and Nagel show that subjective experience remains difficult to reduce. Strawson shows that some physicalists move toward panpsychism rather than eliminativism. These debates make it inaccurate to say "modern philosophy has proved the self is only the brain." It has not. It has, however, set a high evidential burden for any claim of an immortal sentient unit.

Two Western positions not engaged here would sharpen the comparison further. Whitehead's process philosophy is arguably the closest Western analogue to Madhyasth Darshan: it treats plurality as real, relations as ontologically fundamental, and reality as perpetual becoming rather than static substance. Neutral monism (Russell, Mach) resembles the account of Omnipresence as a reality that is neither mind nor matter but the common ground of both. Engaging these would let Madhyasth Darshan be compared with traditions that share its refusal of both world-negation and matter-only reductionism, rather than only with philosophy of mind that mostly does not.

6. Conclusion

Madhyasth Darshan's answer to the paper's three questions is exact:

1. **What is Existence?** Existence is eternally present coexistence: formless Omnipresence and formful units inseparably present.
2. **What exists?** Omnipresence exists; countless sentient and insentient units exist; their form, properties, nature, dharma, mutuality, and orderliness exist.
3. **Does the thing that exists begin at some time?** No. That which exists does not come from non-existence and is not annihilated. Bodies and configurations begin and

end; existence and existent realities persist through transformation.

Its most distinctive formulation is:

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.” - MVD, p. 13

This single line marks the difference from Advaita and modern physicalism at once. Against Advaita, it says the world is not *mithya*. Against physicalism, it says existence is not merely physicochemical matter. Against both, it says reality is neither world-negation nor matter-only, but coexistence.

The philosophical strength of this view is that it makes the world, relationships, conduct, and ecological responsibility fully real. Its unresolved challenge is evidential: to persuade readers outside the tradition, it must clarify how claims such as *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, and post-death continuity can be studied, tested, or at least responsibly distinguished from metaphysical assertion.

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